

11

The KIA against ...g6 Systems

Symmetrical fianchettos, Black's ...e5 or ...c5 choice, and how White creates the first meaningful imbalance.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will avoid sterile copying and know which pawn break makes the g2 bishop and knight routes relevant.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 061 | PAGE 4

Decode: The symmetrical fianchetto shell*Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.*

LESSON 062 | PAGE 8

Play: The symmetrical fianchetto shell*Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.*

LESSON 063 | PAGE 12

Decode: Black closes with ...e5*Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.*

LESSON 064 | PAGE 16

Play: Black closes with ...e5*Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.*

LESSON 065 | PAGE 20

Decode: Black challenges with ...c5*When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.*

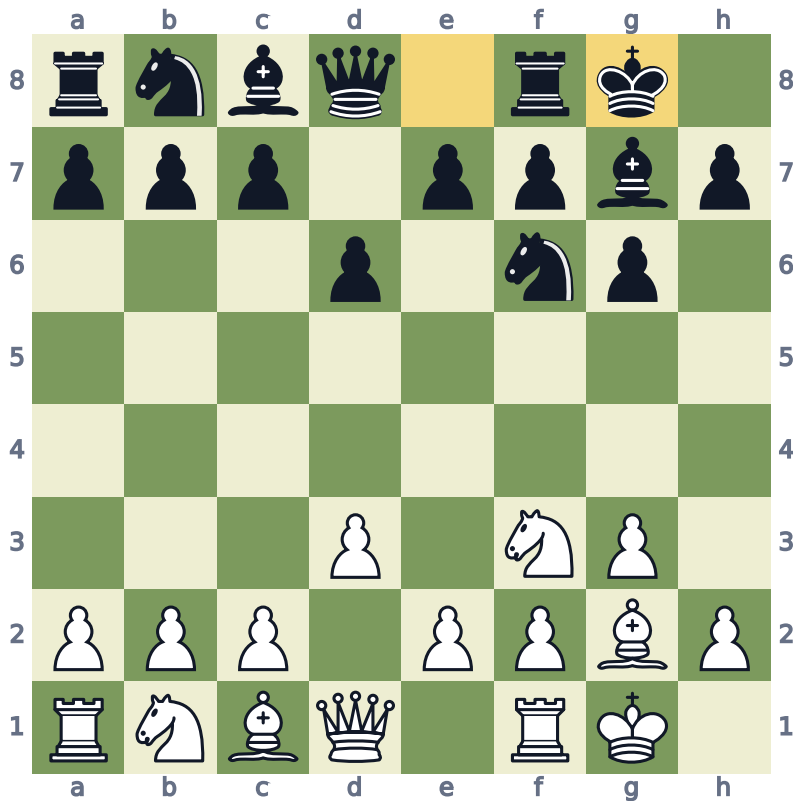
LESSON 066 | PAGE 24

Play: Black challenges with ...c5*When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will avoid sterile copying and know which pawn break makes the g2 bishop and knight routes relevant.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The symmetrical fianchetto shell



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Both sides fianchetto and build e-pawn centers; without a purposeful break, symmetry can leave White with no useful first-move advantage.

DECISION RULE

Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black completes development and seeks ...d5 or queenside expansion while White spends tempi on slow maneuvers.

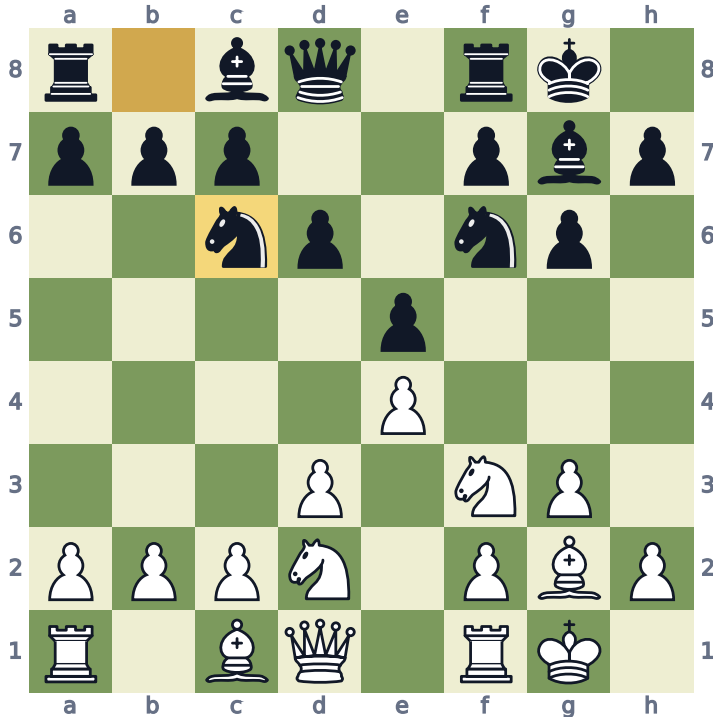
WHITE'S PLAN

White uses the move advantage to prepare c3-d4, f4, or a queenside c4 clamp before Black equalizes.

MEMORY RULE | Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Both sides fianchetto and build e-pawn centers; without a purposeful break, symmetry can leave White with no useful first-move advantage.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black completes development and seeks ...d5 or queenside expansion while White spends tempi on slow maneuvers.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses the move advantage to prepare c3-d4, f4, or a queenside c4 clamp before Black equalizes.

FAILURE MODE

Copying development until Black reaches complete equality and then starting an unsupported attack.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

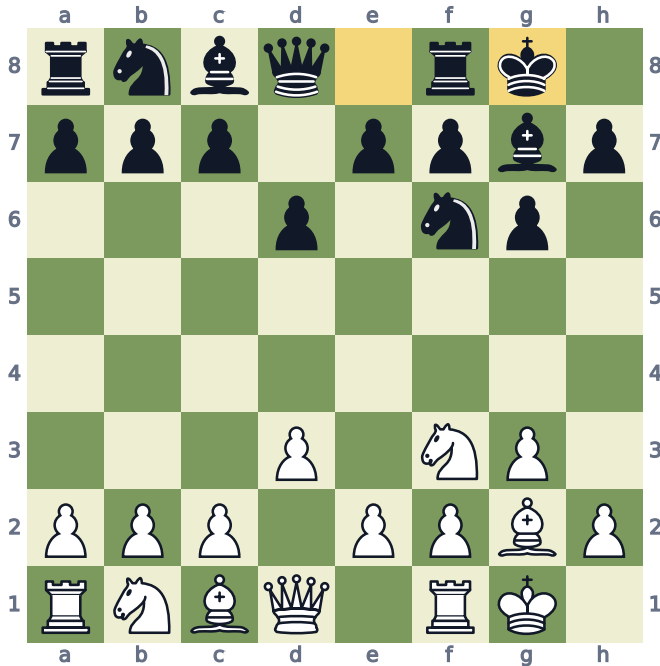
RULE | Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Both sides fianchetto and build e-pawn centers; without a purposeful break, symmetry can leave White with no useful first-move advantage.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses the move advantage to prepare c3-d4, f4, or a queenside c4 clamp before Black equalizes. The line fails as a template when: Copying development until Black reaches complete equality and then starting an unsupported attack.

STORE THIS | Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

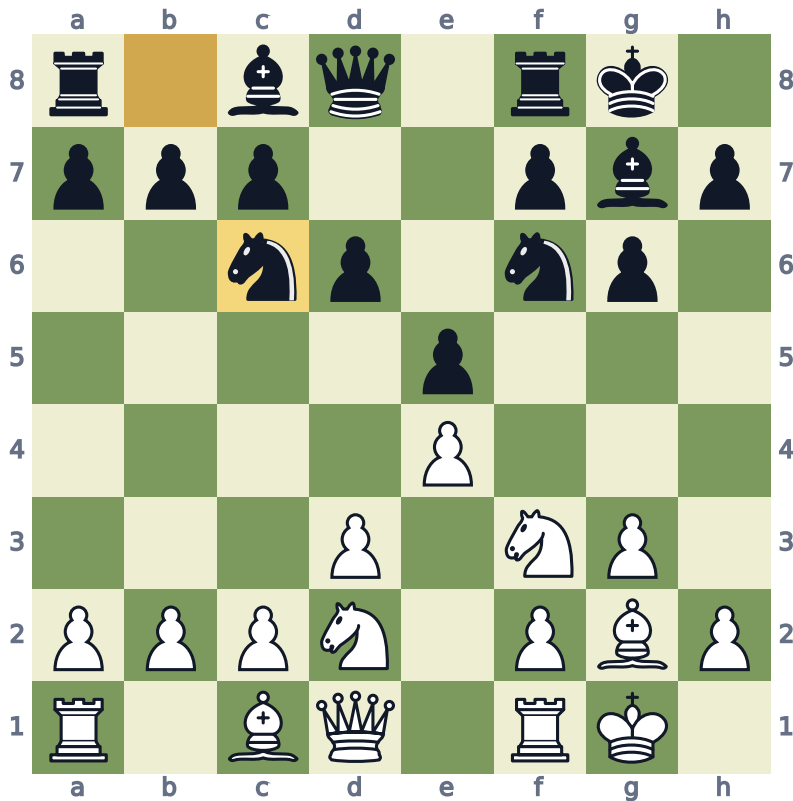
1. Both sides fianchetto and build e-pawn centers; without a purposeful break, symmetry can leave White with no useful first-move advantage. 2. Black completes development and seeks ...d5 or queenside expansion while White spends tempi on slow maneuvers. 3. White uses the move advantage to prepare c3-d4, f4, or a queenside c4 clamp before Black equalizes. 4. Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4? 5. Copying development until Black reaches complete equality and then starting an unsupported attack.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The symmetrical fianchetto shell



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Both sides fianchetto and build e-pawn centers; without a purposeful break, symmetry can leave White with no useful first-move advantage.

DECISION RULE

Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black completes development and seeks ...d5 or queenside expansion while White spends tempi on slow maneuvers.

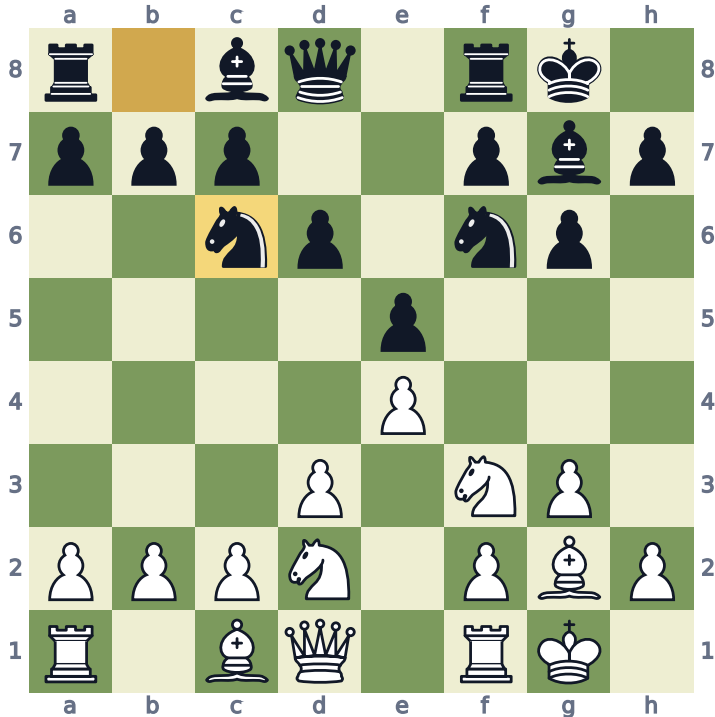
WHITE'S PLAN

White uses the move advantage to prepare c3-d4, f4, or a queenside c4 clamp before Black equalizes.

MEMORY RULE | Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Both sides fianchetto and build e-pawn centers; without a purposeful break, symmetry can leave White with no useful first-move advantage.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black completes development and seeks ...d5 or queenside expansion while White spends tempi on slow maneuvers.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses the move advantage to prepare c3-d4, f4, or a queenside c4 clamp before Black equalizes.

FAILURE MODE

Copying development until Black reaches complete equality and then starting an unsupported attack.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

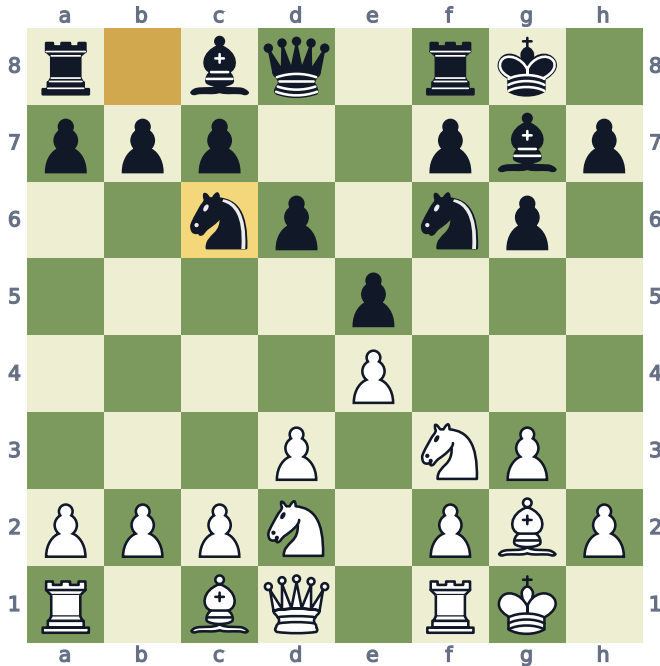
RULE | Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6



- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- e5: Black builds a symmetrical center that requires White to create a new pawn break.
- e4: White builds the KIA center but must account for Black's immediate central break.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Both sides fianchetto and build e-pawn centers; without a purposeful break, symmetry can leave White with no useful first-move advantage.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses the move advantage to prepare c3-d4, f4, or a queenside c4 clamp before Black equalizes. The line fails as a template when: Copying development until Black reaches complete equality and then starting an unsupported attack.

STORE THIS | Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

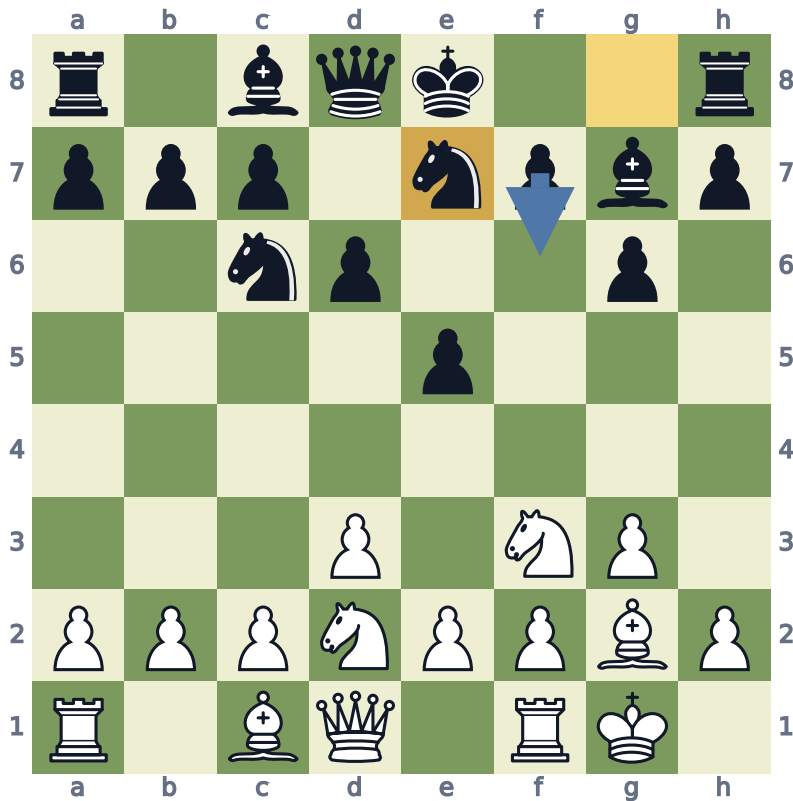
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Black closes with ...e5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Black's ...e5 creates a closed central shell where both sides can maneuver, but White lacks the French-style e5 wedge and must manufacture a break.

DECISION RULE

Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black prepares ...f5, ...Be6, and queenside or kingside expansion depending on White's commitment.

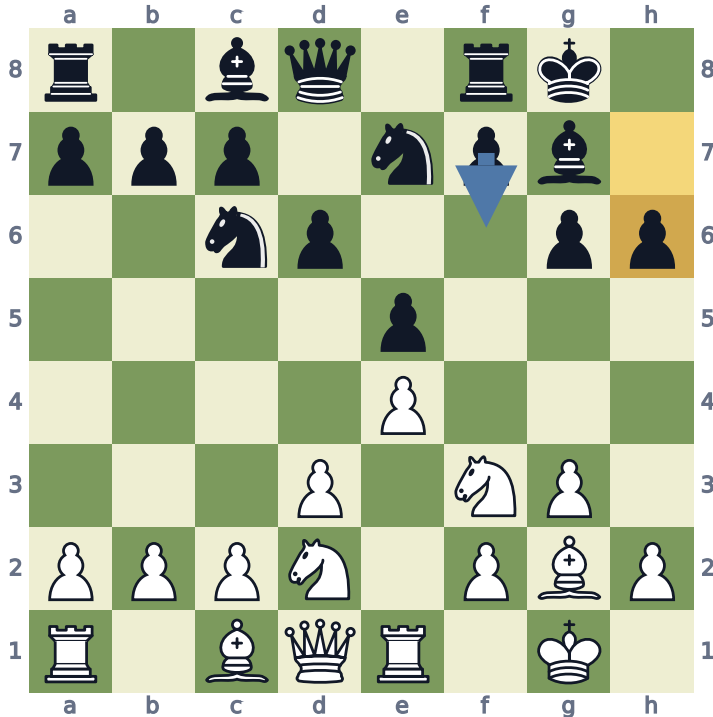
WHITE'S PLAN

White chooses c3-d4, h4, or c4 and routes pieces toward the side where the pawn break will occur.

MEMORY RULE | Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black's ...e5 creates a closed central shell where both sides can maneuver, but White lacks the French-style e5 wedge and must manufacture a break.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black prepares ...f5, ...Be6, and queenside or kingside expansion depending on White's commitment.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White chooses c3-d4, h4, or c4 and routes pieces toward the side where the pawn break will occur.

FAILURE MODE

Using the Nf1-h2-g4 route when there is no kingside target and Black is ready for ...f5.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

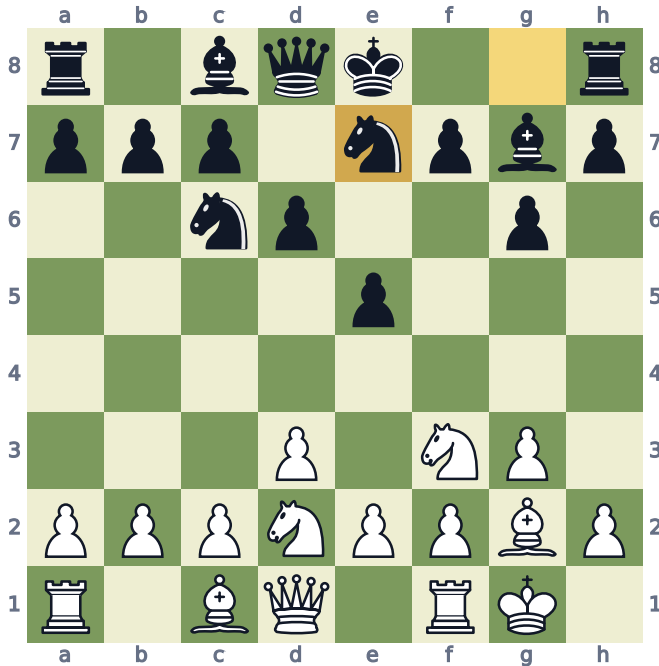
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O e5 5. d3 Nc6 6. Nbd2 Nge7 7. e4 O-O 8. Re1 h6



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- e5: Black builds a symmetrical center that requires White to create a new pawn break.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Nge7: Black reroutes a knight to e7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black's ...e5 creates a closed central shell where both sides can maneuver, but White lacks the French-style e5 wedge and must manufacture a break.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently? White's attacking or positional plan is: White chooses c3-d4, h4, or c4 and routes pieces toward the side where the pawn break will occur. The line fails as a template when: Using the Nf1-h2-g4 route when there is no kingside target and Black is ready for ...f5.

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1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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ANSWER KEY

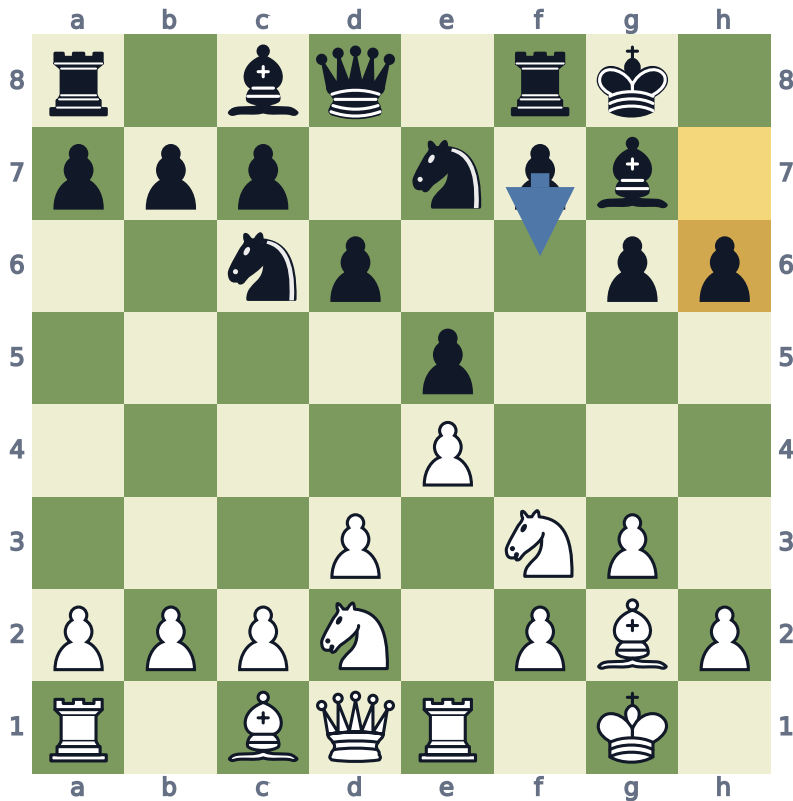
1. Black's ...e5 creates a closed central shell where both sides can maneuver, but White lacks the French-style e5 wedge and must manufacture a break. 2. Black prepares ...f5, ...Be6, and queenside or kingside expansion depending on White's commitment. 3. White chooses c3-d4, h4, or c4 and routes pieces toward the side where the pawn break will occur. 4. Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently? 5. Using the Nf1-h2-g4 route when there is no kingside target and Black is ready for ...f5.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. O-O e5 5. d3 Nc6 6. Nbd2 Nge7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Black closes with ...e5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Black's ...e5 creates a closed central shell where both sides can maneuver, but White lacks the French-style e5 wedge and must manufacture a break.

DECISION RULE

Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black prepares ...f5, ...Be6, and queenside or kingside expansion depending on White's commitment.

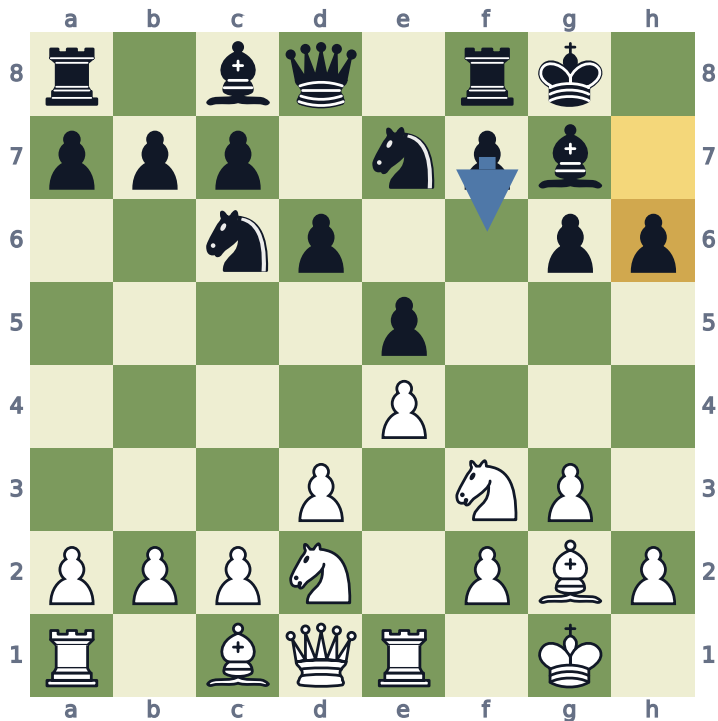
WHITE'S PLAN

White chooses c3-d4, h4, or c4 and routes pieces toward the side where the pawn break will occur.

MEMORY RULE | Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black's ...e5 creates a closed central shell where both sides can maneuver, but White lacks the French-style e5 wedge and must manufacture a break.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black prepares ...f5, ...Be6, and queenside or kingside expansion depending on White's commitment.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White chooses c3-d4, h4, or c4 and routes pieces toward the side where the pawn break will occur.

FAILURE MODE

Using the Nf1-h2-g4 route when there is no kingside target and Black is ready for ...f5.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

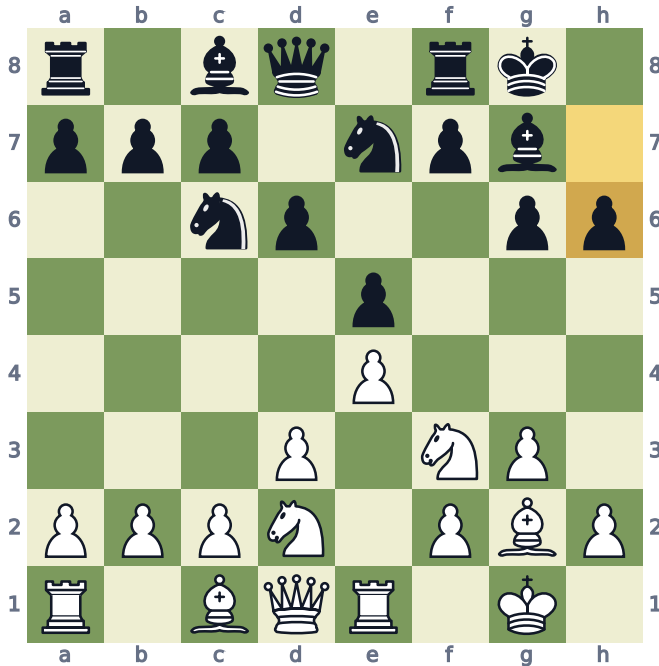
RULE | Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O e5 5. d3 Nc6 6. Nbd2 Nge7 7. e4 O-O 8. Re1 h6



- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Nge7: Black reroutes a knight to e7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- e4: White builds the KIA center but must account for Black's immediate central break.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black's ...e5 creates a closed central shell where both sides can maneuver, but White lacks the French-style e5 wedge and must manufacture a break.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently? White's attacking or positional plan is: White chooses c3-d4, h4, or c4 and routes pieces toward the side where the pawn break will occur. The line fails as a template when: Using the Nf1-h2-g4 route when there is no kingside target and Black is ready for ...f5.

STORE THIS | Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

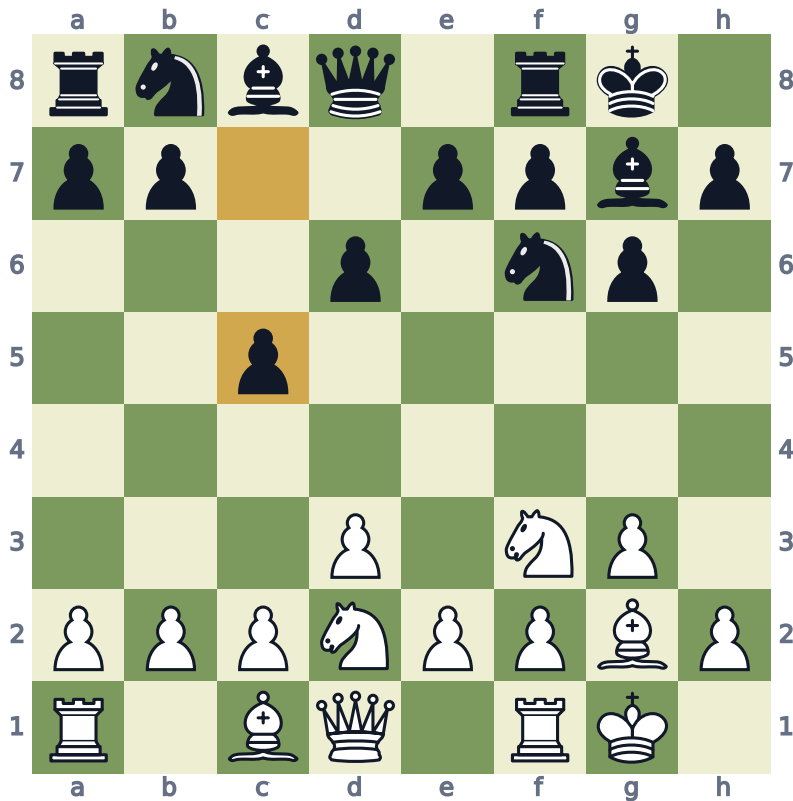
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Nbd2 Nge7 7. e4 O-O 8. Re1 h6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Black challenges with ...c5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow.

DECISION RULE

If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black occupies d4, expands with ...b5, and uses the space if White closes without counterplay.

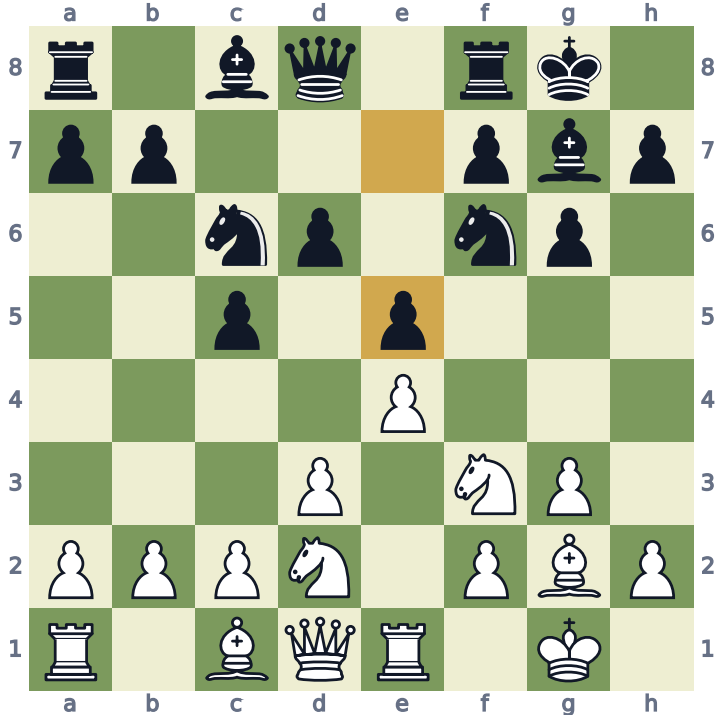
WHITE'S PLAN

White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure.

MEMORY RULE | When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black occupies d4, expands with ...b5, and uses the space if White closes without counterplay.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure.

FAILURE MODE

Completing the usual KIA shell while Black's d4 outpost becomes permanent.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

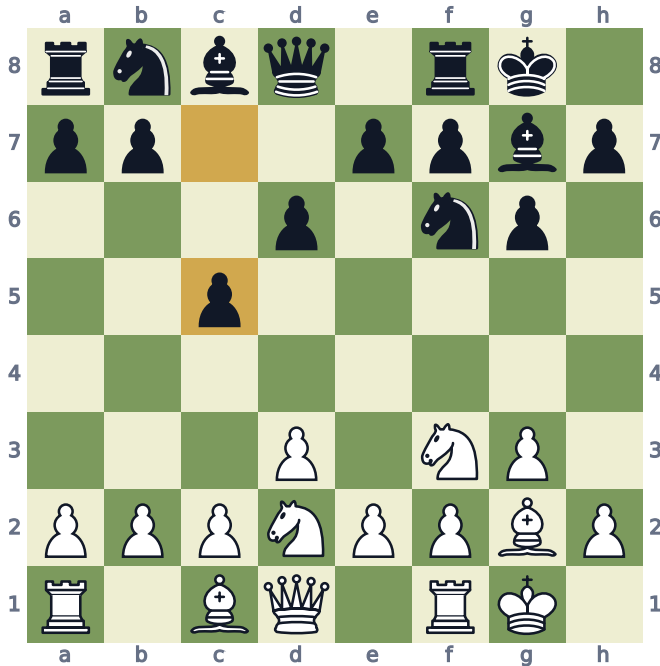
RULE | When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 e5



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center? White's attacking or positional plan is: White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure. The line fails as a template when: Completing the usual KIA shell while Black's d4 outpost becomes permanent.

STORE THIS | When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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ANSWER KEY

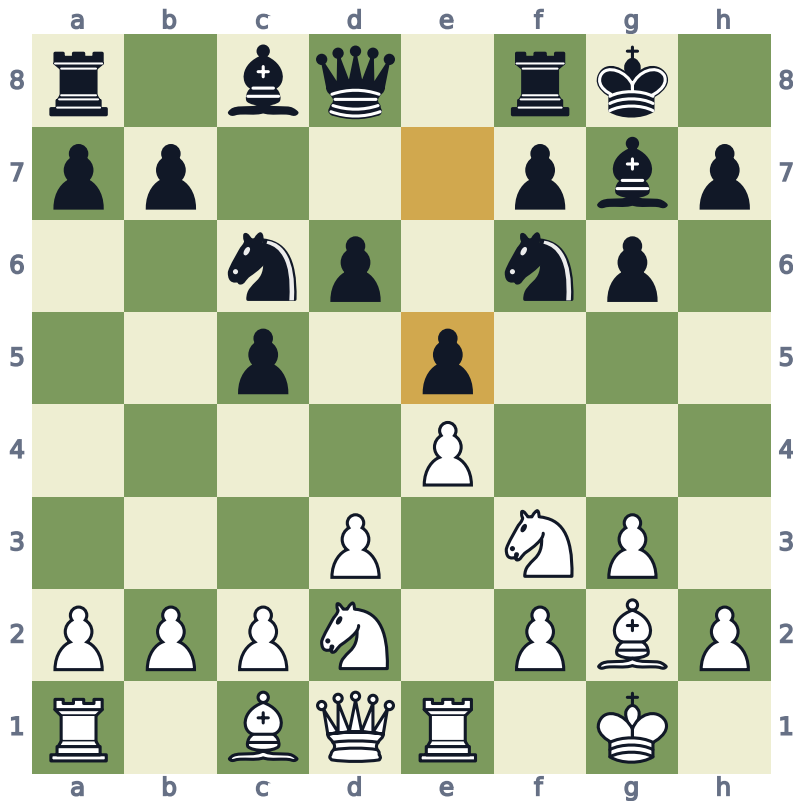
1. ...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow. 2. Black occupies d4, expands with ...b5, and uses the space if White closes without counterplay. 3. White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure. 4. If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center? 5. Completing the usual KIA shell while Black's d4 outpost becomes permanent.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Black challenges with ...c5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow.

DECISION RULE

If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black occupies d4, expands with ...b5, and uses the space if White closes without counterplay.

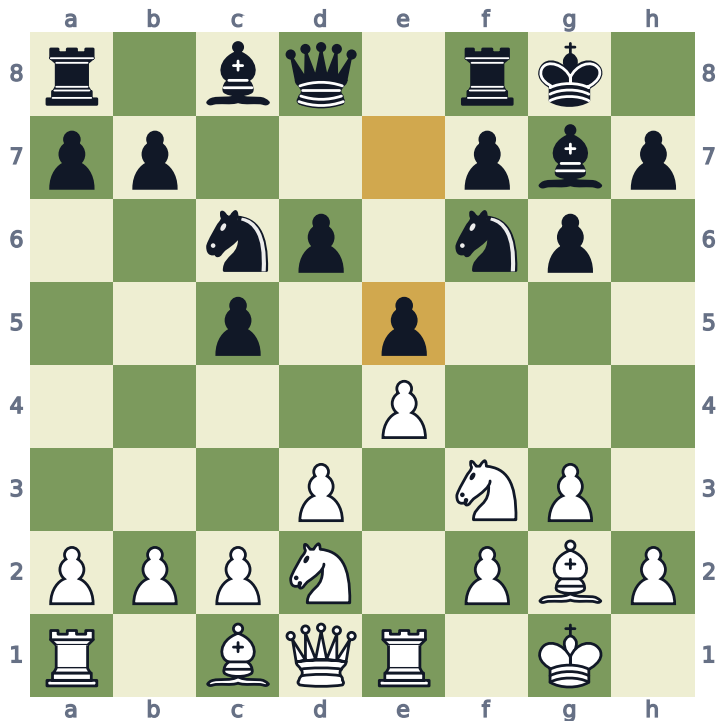
WHITE'S PLAN

White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure.

MEMORY RULE | When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black occupies d4, expands with ...b5, and uses the space if White closes without counterplay.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure.

FAILURE MODE

Completing the usual KIA shell while Black's d4 outpost becomes permanent.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

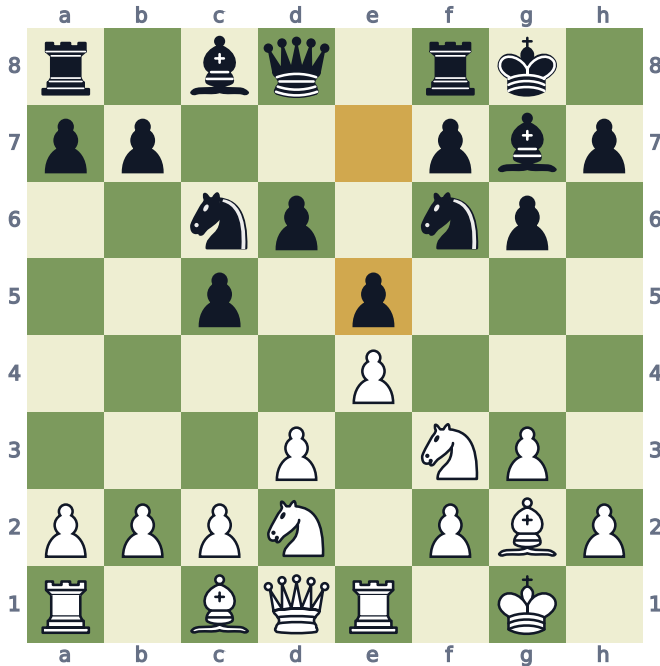
RULE | When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 e5



- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- e4: White builds the KIA center but must account for Black's immediate central break.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- e5: Black builds a symmetrical center that requires White to create a new pawn break.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center? White's attacking or positional plan is: White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure. The line fails as a template when: Completing the usual KIA shell while Black's d4 outpost becomes permanent.

STORE THIS | When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. ...c5 controls d4 and can create a Botvinnik-style center; White must decide whether the d4 break remains possible or c3 is too slow. 2. Black occupies d4, expands with ...b5, and uses the space if White closes without counterplay. 3. White attacks the dark squares with c3, a3-b4, or f4 and avoids a passive version of the same structure. 4. If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center? 5. Completing the usual KIA shell while Black's d4 outpost becomes permanent.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 e5

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 061 Decode: The symmetrical fianchetto shell

Prompt: Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4?

Recall: Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

LESSON 062 Play: The symmetrical fianchetto shell

Prompt: Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4?

Recall: Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

LESSON 063 Decode: Black closes with ...e5

Prompt: Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently?

Recall: Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.

LESSON 064 Play: Black closes with ...e5

Prompt: Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently?

Recall: Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.

LESSON 065 Decode: Black challenges with ...c5

Prompt: If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center?

Recall: When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

LESSON 066 Play: Black challenges with ...c5

Prompt: If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center?

Recall: When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The symmetrical fianchetto shell

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6

Decision: Which asymmetry can White create without weakening the king or surrendering d4?

Memory: Symmetry is broken by a pawn break, not by wishing one side had an attack.

CARD 2

Black closes with ...e5

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O e5 5. d3 Nc6 6. Nbd2 Nge7 7. e4 O-O 8. Re1 h6

Decision: Which break challenges Black's e5 pawn without locking White's own g2 bishop permanently?

Memory: Closed symmetry needs a planned break before a planned maneuver.

CARD 3

Black challenges with ...c5

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 e5

Decision: If Black installs a piece on d4, can White exchange it without damaging the center?

Memory: When ...c5 controls d4, decide how to challenge the outpost before attacking the king.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
061 Decode: The symmetrical fianchetto shell	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
062 Play: The symmetrical fianchetto shell	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
063 Decode: Black closes with ...e5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
064 Play: Black closes with ...e5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
065 Decode: Black challenges with ...c5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
066 Play: Black challenges with ...c5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.